

Insights Summary

My journey through the LEADS Inspired Leadership program has been defined by a single, powerful realization: technical excellence is not synonymous with effective leadership. When I began this program, I viewed leadership primarily through the lens of accountability—being the most reliable, error-free technician in the dispensary. However, my domain assignments have revealed that my rigid focus on "tasks" often came at the expense of "people." This summary reflects my transformation from a guardian of standards to a builder of capacity, highlighting the unique strengths I bring, my evolved definition of success, and my readiness to lead meaningful change.

The first key insight regarding my leadership is that I bring a unique blend of unwavering accountability and systems-thinking fairness to my organization. In my Lead Self and Engage Others assignments, 360-degree feedback confirmed that my team views me as technically rock-solid but interpersonally distant. Initially, I saw this distance as professionalism. Now, I understand it as a missed opportunity to connect.

However, my strength lies in my ability to "operationalize" values. I do not just "feel" fairness; I build it into the workflow. As identified in my Engage Others analysis, I am learning to shift my reaction to errors from "correction" to "curiosity." By asking, "Did the workflow make this difficult?" rather than blaming the individual, I leverage my deep technical knowledge to fix the system rather than scold the person. This blend—the reliability to spot the error and the fairness to fix the root cause—positions me as a leader who protects both the patient and the provider.

Consequently, my definition of success has shifted fundamentally. In the past, I measured success by the metrics on the dashboard: zero errors, empty queues, and fast wait times. My Achieve Results assignment challenged this narrow view. I realized that achieving "Excellence" (speed) often compromised "Care" (well-being), leading to a team that was high-performing but burnt out.

Today, I measure success by sustainability. Success is no longer just clearing the queue today; it is clearing the queue in a way that ensures my team is healthy enough to come back and do it again tomorrow. As outlined in my Achieve Results reflection, I now track success through "psychological safety"—do my technicians feel safe enough to ask for a break? Do they feel supported during a rush? If the metrics are green but the team is breaking, I have failed. True success is when high performance is fueled by a supported, resilient team, not by anxiety and adrenaline.

Finally, I feel far more prepared to lead organizational change, specifically regarding the "human element" of transformation. My Systems Transformation assignment was a pivotal moment in my learning. In planning the "Sustainable Safety Initiative" (the daily wellness huddle), I initially assumed that because the huddle was a "good idea" that improved safety, the team would embrace it.

The Change Analysis taught me that logic is not enough; capacity is king. I learned that a burnt-out team cannot process new initiatives, no matter how beneficial they are. This realization has reshaped my approach to leadership. I am now prepared to lead change not by adding more "to-dos" to the list, but by first assessing the "emotional residue" and capacity of my stakeholders. My strategy has shifted from simply "announcing the plan" to "clearing the path"—removing low-value barriers to create the space for high-value changes. I am ready to lead not by force of will, but by facilitating readiness.

In conclusion, the LEADS program has helped me bridge the gap between my intent and my impact. I am no longer just a "reliable technician"; I am a leader who understands that the ultimate safety mechanism in any pharmacy is not a software alert, but a supported, engaged, and well-rested team. By balancing my natural accountability with a newfound commitment to compassion, I am ready to help my organization achieve results that are not just excellent, but sustainable.